

Get the Response of a PATCH API Request

Partial Update of a Booking with PATCH in Postman

Hands-On	9
Scenario	Get the response of PATCH API Request
Tool	Postman (Desktop or Web)
Method	PATCH
Endpoint URL	https://restful-booker.herokuapp.com/booking/:id
Auth	Basic Auth (admin / password123)
Duration	20 minutes
Prerequisite	An existing bookingid from a previous POST /booking

Objective

The objective of this assignment is to send a **PATCH** request from Postman to update *only specific fields* of an existing booking on the Restful Booker API. Unlike PUT, PATCH performs a **partial update** — the request body contains *just* the fields that should change, and the server keeps every other existing field untouched.

PATCH vs PUT — Key Difference

PUT replaces the entire resource — every field that the booking should have after the update must be present in the request body, otherwise it will be removed or rejected. **PATCH** applies a **partial update** — the body contains only the fields that need to change. Any field not included is left as it was before the request. This makes PATCH the right choice for small, focused edits like changing only a price or a check-in date.

Note on Authorization

Just like PUT, the Restful Booker API protects PATCH operations and requires authorization. This assignment uses **HTTP Basic Auth** with the documented admin credentials — username **admin** and password **password123**. Postman encodes them to Base64 and attaches an **Authorization: Basic <...>** header automatically.

Steps to Send the PATCH Request

1 Go to the Right Workspace

Open Postman and sign in if not already logged in.

Click the **Workspaces** dropdown and select the workspace used in the previous assignments.

2 Go to the Right Collection

In the left sidebar, click the **Collections** tab.

Open the collection that contains the previous booking requests.

3 Add a New Request

Click the **Add a request** link inside the collection, or use the three-dot (...) menu next to the collection name and choose **Add request**.

4 New Tab Opens with the Empty Request

Postman opens a new request tab in the central panel with default method **GET** and an empty URL.

5 Give the Request a Meaningful Name

Rename the request to something descriptive such as *Patch Booking* or *PATCH Restful Booker Booking*.

Save with **Ctrl + S** / **Cmd + S**.

6 Set the HTTP Method to PATCH

Click the **method dropdown** on the left of the URL field.

Select **PATCH** from the list. PATCH is used for **partial updates** — only the fields supplied in the body are changed on the server.

7 Configure Basic Auth

Click the **Authorization** tab below the URL bar.

From the **Type** dropdown, choose **Basic Auth**.

Enter the credentials:

- **Username:** admin
- **Password:** password123

8 Set the Request URL with Path Parameter

Click into the URL field and enter:

`https://restful-booker.herokuapp.com/booking/:id`

Open the **Params** tab and set the **id** path variable to the bookingid returned from the earlier POST /booking call (for example 4271).

9 Add the Partial Update Body

Click the **Body** tab.

Choose the **raw** radio option and select **JSON** from the format dropdown.

Paste only the fields that should change. There is **no need** to include the entire booking — that's the whole point of PATCH.

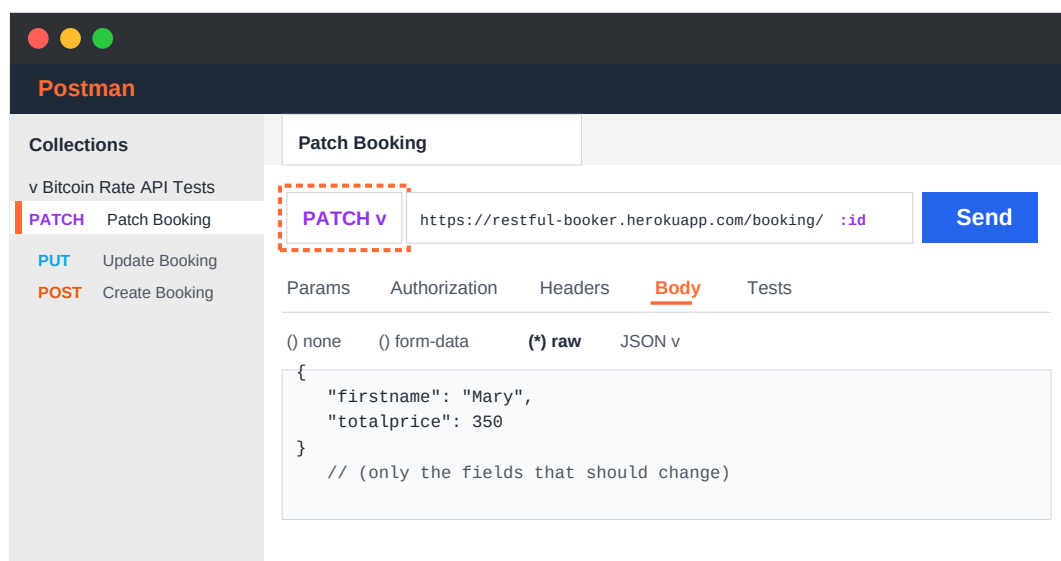


Figure 1 — PATCH request configured: method **PATCH**, URL with **:id**, and a small JSON body containing only the fields that should change.

Sample Request Body (Input)

If no input file is provided, use this small partial-update payload. It changes only the firstname and the totalprice; everything else on the existing booking is left untouched:

```
{
  "firstname" : "Mary",
  "totalprice" : 350
}
```

10 Click the “Send” Button and Verify the Response

Click the blue **Send** button.

Postman dispatches the PATCH request and displays the server's response in the **Response** panel.

Verify the following:

- **Status** — should be **200 OK** in green.
- **Body** — contains the **full booking** with the updated fields applied. Untouched fields keep their previous values.
- **Time / Size** — well under a second.

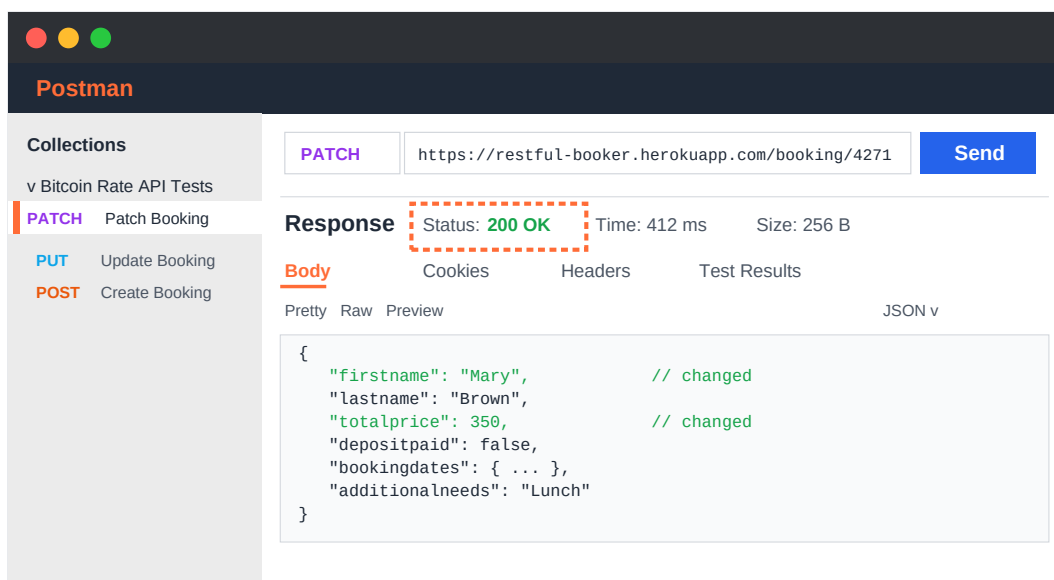


Figure 2 — Response panel with status **200 OK**. The **full booking** is returned; only **firstname** and **totalprice** (highlighted) reflect the patched values.

Expected Response

On success, the server returns **HTTP 200 OK** with the complete booking object. The patched fields show the new values; all other fields keep their pre-existing values:

```
{
  "firstname": "Mary",    // changed
  "lastname": "Brown",
  "totalprice": 350,      // changed
  "depositpaid": false,
  "bookingdates": { ... },
  "additionalneeds": "Lunch"
}
```

If the response shows **403 Forbidden**, double-check the Basic Auth credentials. If it shows **405 Method Not Allowed**, the bookingid in the URL no longer exists (the API resets every 10 minutes). Re-create with a fresh POST and patch the new id.

Verification Checklist

- 1 Status code is **200 OK**.

- 2 Response body contains the **full booking** — not just the fields that were sent.
- 3 Patched fields show the **new** values.
- 4 All non-patched fields show their **previous** values, unchanged.
- 5 Basic Auth credentials are set correctly under **Authorization**.
- 6 Request is saved (**Ctrl + S / Cmd + S**) inside the collection.

Conclusion

A PATCH request to partially update an existing booking has been successfully sent and the response verified. PATCH is the appropriate verb whenever only a subset of a resource's fields needs to change — it produces smaller payloads, lower risk of accidentally wiping out existing data, and clearer intent than a full PUT replace. The same booking id will be reused in the upcoming DELETE assignment.